

Custom Status Line (Your Mascot)

The bar at the bottom of Claude Code. Put an emoji, your name, the time, or a full dashboard with git branch and model name.

What it does

The status line is a thin bar that sits at the bottom of Claude Code at all times. You can set it to static text (a mascot emoji, a motto) — or to a shell script that updates every few seconds with live info like your current git branch, model name, cost, or time of day.

Why it's fun

It's the one spot that's always visible. Everyone who sees your terminal sees it. It's the closest thing Claude Code has to a "home screen" — and you can make it yours.

How to set it up — Level 1 (simple emoji)

1. Open `~/.claude/settings.json`
2. Add the `statusLine` block below
3. Save. It shows up immediately at the bottom.

Copy-paste starter — simple mascot

```
{
  "statusLine": {
    "type": "text",
    "text": "🤖 Claude Code — let's build"
  }
}
```

That's it. Replace the emoji and text with anything you want.

Level 2 — dynamic script

If you want live info (git branch, time of day, model), point to a shell script instead:

```
{
  "statusLine": {
    "type": "command",
    "command": "~/.claude/statusline.sh",
    "refreshInterval": 10
  }
}
```

Create `~/.claude/statusline.sh` :

```
#!/bin/bash
BRANCH=$(git rev-parse --abbrev-ref HEAD 2>/dev/null || echo "-")
HOUR=$(date +%H)
if [ $HOUR -lt 12 ]; then MOOD="☀ Morning"; else MOOD="🌙 Evening"; fi
echo "$MOOD 🌱 $BRANCH"
```

Then make it executable: `chmod +x ~/.claude/statusline.sh`

Fun ideas to try

- **Mascot:** "🦄 You're a unicorn" or "👩 Built by Mariana"
- **Motto:** "🌟 Ship it 🌟" or "Walk before you fly"
- **Current state:** time of day, weather icon, mood emoji
- **Project-aware:** show current project name, client name, or focus area
- **Progress tracker:** word count of an active draft, PRs open, tests passing

Shortcut: let Claude.ai write the script

Don't know bash? Describe what you want in [Claude.ai](#):

*Write me a bash script for Claude Code's `statusLine` command that shows **[WHAT YOU WANT]**. Return the full script ready to save as `~/.claude/statusline.sh`, plus the `chmod` step to make it executable and the JSON snippet for `settings.json`.*

Examples to describe:

- "Current git branch, current time, and a rocket emoji"
- "The name of the project folder I'm in and today's date"
- "A motivational quote that changes every time it refreshes"
- "Whether my internet is working (ping google.com) plus battery percentage"

Claude.ai will write the bash for you — you just save it and run `chmod +x`.

Heads up

If you use a shell script, keep it fast — it runs every few seconds. No API calls, no slow git commands, no network waits. Cache anything that doesn't change often.

Docs: code.claude.com/docs/en/statusline — one of 7 in the Fun Claude Code series